

Build Web Apps with the Express Framework

Built on the Node.js platform, Express is a minimal and flexible Web application framework that provides a strong set of features for building single, multi-page and hybrid Web applications. Here is a step-by-step guide that leads readers through installing the Express framework and building a photo viewer Web application.



start your applications. It even has sufficient options to choose the extensions or libraries that you are comfortable with.

The components of Express

At first sight, Express might seem a big challenge, even confusing. It could take a few days or weeks to get a complete understanding of Express. It can be understood easily if you know a particular set of three objects and *connect* middleware. The three objects are *app* (or application), *req* (request) and *res* (response). The object *app* is used for application settings such as 'views', 'view engine' and middleware. The *req* object is the HTTP request that comes from the client (typically a browser). The *res* object is the HTTP response from the server to the client.

connect is the middleware Node package, which itself is a set of functions. The functionality performed between the request received from the browser and the response sent back to browser is the function of middleware. The functionalities like logging, routing to user requested page,

Express.js is the popular Web application framework for the Node environment. It helps developers with simple, yet powerful capabilities that augment Node.

Node.js has established itself as a robust environment for developing complex server-based software. One such application is Web development. The success of Node is attributed to many factors, the most important being the growing number of packages. Express is an example of making a complete framework built on other packages.

Express has the capability of starting a small project with limited functionality and extending it to an enterprise grade product. The typical Model, View, Controller (MVC) design pattern can be fully realised using this framework. Express not only offers programming capability as an API, it also provides skeleton programmes (templates) to